



ALBUKHARY INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY

PROPOSAL PAPER FOR INFORMATION / APPROVAL OF

THE VICE-CHANCELLOR AND PRESIDENT OF
ALBUKHARY INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY

PROPOSAL FOR PROGRAM APPROVAL AND BUDGET APPROVAL :

CipherNest Cyber Talk Series 1.0

“Breaking Into Cybersecurity: Career Paths, Skills & Real-World Insights”

1.0 PURPOSE

The purpose of this proposal is to **seek approval from the Dean of the School of Computing and Informatics (SCI), Associate Professor Dr. Basheer Riskhan, and YBhg. Prof. Dato’ as the Vice-Chancellor and President of Albukhary International University**, to organise a **programme titled “CipherNest Cyber Talk Series 1.0 (Breaking Into Cybersecurity: Career Paths, Skills & Real-World Insights).”**

This proposal also seeks approval for the overall programme execution and budget allocation to support the successful implementation of the event, ensuring smooth coordination and effective delivery of all planned activities.

This programme is organised by the CipherNest Cybersecurity Three Zero Club under the School of Computing and Informatics (SCI). The initiative will be conducted as a one-day physical event aimed at students of Albukhary International University who are interested in gaining foundational knowledge in cybersecurity, including key concepts, digital safety practices, and an overview of cybersecurity career pathways and industry roadmap exposure.

The programme will also be conducted in collaboration with the School of Computing and Informatics (SCI) and several student country associations, through their respective committees, to enhance participation, encourage cross-cultural engagement, and broaden the reach of cybersecurity awareness among the student community.

In addition, this programme serves as a platform to strengthen student engagement in cybersecurity-related activities under CipherNest Cybersecurity Three Zero Club established under SCI. This student-led initiative is fully managed within the school and focuses on promoting cybersecurity awareness, skill development, and industry exposure by introducing students to real-world cybersecurity practices, career pathways, and the broader cybersecurity career roadmap aligned with current industry demands and the university's Three Zero principles.

The initiative also aligns with the university's commitment to innovation, digital literacy, and student-led academic engagement, while enhancing students' exposure to real-world cybersecurity practices and industry-relevant competencies.

2.0 CONTEXT

2.1 BACKGROUND

The cybersecurity industry has become one of the fastest-growing sectors within the global digital economy, driven by increasing cyber threats, data breaches, and the rising need for secure digital infrastructure. As organizations across all industries adopt digital systems, cybersecurity has shifted from a niche technical field to a critical career domain with high global demand.

However, many students in computing and related disciplines often lack clarity on how to enter the cybersecurity field, what career paths exist, and how it compares to other areas such as data science, software development, and artificial intelligence. There is also limited exposure to real-world industry expectations, required skill sets, and practical career progression routes within cybersecurity.

To address this gap, **CipherNest 3 zero club under the School of Computing and Informatics (SCI) proposes the organisation of a talk titled “Breaking Into Cybersecurity: Career Paths, Skills & Real-World Insights.”** The session is designed to provide students

with direct exposure to cybersecurity as a career pathway, including industry structure, job roles, required competencies, and practical insights from real-world practice.

The programme will be conducted in collaboration with the School of Computing and Informatics (SCI) and student country associations within Albukhary International University to ensure wider participation and diverse student engagement across disciplines.

Furthermore, this initiative strengthens CipherNest Cybersecurity Three Zero Club under SCI, by positioning it as a student-driven platform that connects academic learning with industry expectations, career development pathways, and real-world cybersecurity exposure aligned with current global demands and the university's Three Zero principles.

2.2 JUSTIFICATION

The proposed programme is necessary due to the lack of structured exposure among students regarding cybersecurity as a career pathway. While students are often introduced to computing disciplines in general, they are not always provided with clear, practical guidance on how to enter cybersecurity, what roles exist within the field, and how it compares strategically with other tech domains such as data science and software engineering.

This talk directly addresses that gap by focusing on career pathways, essential skill sets, industry expectations, and real-world cybersecurity insights. It helps students understand not only what cybersecurity is, but how professionals actually build careers within the industry.

Additionally, collaboration with SCI and student country associations increases outreach and ensures broader engagement across different student backgrounds, encouraging informed career exploration and interdisciplinary awareness.

The initiative also aligns with the university's focus on employability, innovation, and industry readiness by providing students with exposure to a high-demand global career field and practical insights that support informed academic and professional decision-making.

2.3 STAKEHOLDER BENEFITS

This programme provides clear and targeted benefits to multiple stakeholders:

Students will gain practical understanding of how to break into cybersecurity, including entry-level career paths, required technical and soft skills, and real-world industry expectations. They will also gain clarity on how cybersecurity compares to other computing fields, enabling more informed career planning and decision-making.

The School of Computing and Informatics (SCI) will benefit through enhanced student awareness of cybersecurity career opportunities, stronger alignment between academic learning and industry needs, and increased visibility of CipherNest as a career-focused student initiative.

Albukhary International University (AIU) will benefit from improved student employability awareness, stronger industry relevance in student activities, and alignment with global demand for cybersecurity professionals.

Student country associations will benefit through increased participation in career-oriented academic events, stronger student engagement, and opportunities to collaborate in professional development initiatives.

Overall, the programme positions CipherNest as a structured platform that bridges the gap between academic learning and real-world cybersecurity careers, equipping students with clarity, direction, and industry-relevant exposure.

3.0 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The CipherNest Cybersecurity Three Zero Club under the School of Computing and Informatics (SCI) proposes to organise a programme titled *"Breaking Into Cybersecurity: Career Paths, Skills & Real-World Insights"*, aimed at providing students of Albukhary International University with exposure to cybersecurity as a career pathway and industry field. The programme will be conducted as a **one-day physical event on 29th June 2026 from 8:00 PM to 10:00 PM at the AIU Auditorium**, focusing on cybersecurity career roadmap, industry expectations, required technical and soft skills, and practical insights into the cybersecurity profession.

The programme is designed to provide students with a clearer understanding of how to enter the cybersecurity field, the different career opportunities available, and the competencies required to succeed in an increasingly digital and security-driven world. The session will also highlight why cybersecurity continues to emerge as a highly relevant and in-demand field within the technology industry.

In addition, **the programme will feature a guest speaker who is an AIU alumnus and a graduate of the School of Computing and Informatics (SCI), currently working as a cybersecurity consultant and Security Researcher in the industry**, providing real-world insights, career experiences, and practical exposure from an industry perspective.

The programme will strengthen the role of CipherNest Cybersecurity Three Zero Club established under the School of Computing and Informatics, as a platform for cybersecurity-related learning, industry exposure, and student engagement. The initiative aims to bridge the gap between academic learning and real-world industry expectations by introducing students to practical career insights and professional development opportunities.

The programme will be conducted in collaboration with the School of Computing and Informatics (SCI) and student country associations within the university to enhance participation, encourage inclusivity, and strengthen engagement across diverse student communities. Through this collaboration, the programme seeks to broaden outreach and create meaningful interdisciplinary learning opportunities.

The proposed programme aligns with Albukhary International University's commitment to innovation, employability, digital literacy, and student-led initiatives. By providing students with direct exposure to cybersecurity career pathways and real-world industry insights, the programme is expected to support informed career decision-making and strengthen students' readiness for future opportunities in the digital economy.

3.1 OBJECTIVES

The objectives of this programme are:

1. To provide students with exposure to cybersecurity career pathways, industry roles, and professional opportunities within the cybersecurity field.
2. To introduce students to the essential technical and soft skills required to build a successful career in cybersecurity.
3. To provide real-world industry insights and practical understanding of the cybersecurity profession, trends, and expectations.
4. To help students understand the relevance and growing demand for cybersecurity in comparison to other technology-related career fields.
5. To strengthen student engagement in cybersecurity-related learning and professional development activities under CipherNest Cybersecurity Three Zero Club.

4.0 PROPOSAL

4.1 PROGRAM DETAILS, FORMAT & SCHEDULE

Item	Details
Programme Name	<i>Breaking Into Cybersecurity: Career Paths, Skills & Real-World Insights</i>
Mode	Physical
Venue	Auditorium, AIU
Proposed Date	29th June 2026 (Monday)

Proposed Time	8:00 PM – 10:00 PM
Target Audience	All students of Albukhary International University
Speaker	Md Amin Ullah Sheikh (<i>Albukhary International University Alumnus graduate from School of Computing and Informatics / Cybersecurity Consultant/Security Researcher</i>)
Programme Format	One-session cybersecurity career talk with industry exposure, interactive Q&A session, and cybersecurity-related engagement activity.
Collaborating Organizations	School of Computing & Informatics (SCI), Student Country Associations Committee
Special Segment	Kahoot quiz segment, Interactive Cybersecurity related game and lucky draw

4.2 FUNDAMENTALS

Component	Description
Topics Covered	• Introduction to cybersecurity as a career field • Understanding cybersecurity career pathways and roadmap • Why cybersecurity over other computing fields such as data science • Essential technical and soft skills required in cybersecurity • Industry expectations and real-world cybersecurity practices • Certifications, internships, and opportunities in cybersecurity

	• Breaking into cybersecurity: challenges, opportunities, and career growth
Speaker Session	Sharing session by invited cybersecurity speaker on career roadmap, industry exposure, and practical insights into the cybersecurity profession.
Interactive Session	Q&A session with speaker to allow student engagement, networking, and clarification regarding cybersecurity careers and skill development.
Cybersecurity Activity	Interactive cybersecurity-related game/activity to encourage student participation and reinforce learning.
Speeches Included	Dean's Speech, Club Advisor's Speech, and CipherNest President's Opening Remarks.
Outcome	Students will gain a better understanding of cybersecurity career pathways, required skills, industry expectations, and future professional opportunities.

4.3 PROGRAM FLOW

CipherNest Cyber Talk Series 1.0

“Breaking Into Cybersecurity: Career Paths, Skills & Real-World Insights”

Date: 29th June 2026

Time: 8:00 PM – 10:00 PM

Venue: Auditorium, School of Computing & Informatics (SCI), AIU

Time	Activity
8:00 PM – 8:05 PM	Arrival of Participants & Registration

8:05 PM – 8:10 PM	Dua Recitation
8:10 PM – 8:15 PM	Opening Remarks by President of CipherNest Cybersecurity Club
8:15 PM – 8:20 PM	Acknowledgement of Collaborating Parties
8:20 PM – 8:30 PM	Speech by Dean, School of Computing & Informatics
8:30 PM – 8:35 PM	Speech by CipherNest CyberSecurity Club Advisor
8:35 PM – 9:20 PM	Speaker Session: <i>"Breaking Into Cybersecurity: Career Paths, Skills & Real-World Insights"</i> by the Guest Speaker
9:20 PM – 9:35 PM	Interactive Q&A Session
9:35 PM – 9:50 PM	Interactive Cybersecurity Game / Lucky Draw & Kahoot Game
9:50 PM – 9:55 PM	Presentation of Token of Appreciation
9:55 PM – 10:00 PM	Closing Remarks by SCI president & Group Photo

4.4 EQUIPMENT AND FACILITY REQUEST

No	Item Requested	Quantity
1	Microphones	2
2	Microphone Stand	1
3	HDMI Cable	1
4	Audio Cable	1
5	Projector Remote	1

4.5 EXTERNAL GUEST DECLARATION

No	Full Name	Organization	Purpose of Invitation
1	Md Amin Ullah Sheikh	AIU Alumni from School of Computing and Informatics / Cybersecurity Consultant/Security Researcher	Cybersecurity career talk on "Breaking Into Cybersecurity: Career Paths, Skills & Real-World Insights"

4.6 BUDGET

No	Description	Unit	Total (RM)	Remarks
1	Transportation (Speaker)	1	RM 400	
2	Accommodation (Speaker)	1	RM 400	

3	Food (Speaker + VIP)	15 pax × RM 7	RM 140	
4	Kahoot & Lucky draw Prizes	20 units × RM 10	RM 200	
5	Refreshments (Students)	Apollo cake, drinks (15 pax × RM 10; 15 bottles × RM 3; 15 pax × RM 10.5)	RM 0	Sponsored by Country Associations
6	Promotional Materials (2 banners)	Banner	RM 250	
7	Appreciation Tokens (Speaker + Associations + VIP)	15 units	RM 350	
Total			RM 1740	

5.0 RECOMMENDATION

In line with the CipherNest Cybersecurity Three Zero Club's commitment to promoting cybersecurity awareness, digital literacy, and career readiness among students, it is recommended that the programme entitled **“Breaking Into Cybersecurity: Career Paths, Skills & Real-World Insights”** be approved as proposed.

Approval is sought for:

1. The organization of the programme is on **29th June 2026 (Monday) from 8:00 PM to 10:00 PM at the AIU Auditorium.**
2. The booking and utilisation of the AIU Auditorium as the official venue for the programme, including access for setup, programme implementation, and post-event arrangements.

3. The provision of ICT and technical support, including microphones, audio system connectivity, HDMI connection, and display facilities to ensure the smooth execution of the programme.
4. The allocation of the required budget to support speaker engagement, logistical arrangements, and other operational requirements necessary for the successful implementation of the programme.
5. The participation of students, CipherNest Cybersecurity Three Zero Club committee members, and support from the School of Computing and Informatics (SCI) and student country associations to ensure the successful delivery of the programme.

This programme will serve as a valuable platform to expose students to cybersecurity career pathways, industry expectations, required technical and professional skills, and real-world insights from an AIU alumnus currently working in the cybersecurity industry. It will further strengthen students' career preparedness, industry awareness, and understanding of opportunities within the cybersecurity field while supporting the university's commitment to innovation, employability, and digital literacy under the Three Zero principles.

6.0 ENDORSEMENT



Prepared by :

Name: **Mohammad Hafil**

Designation: Secretary of CipherNest Cybersecurity Club

Date: 29.05.2026



Reviewed by:

Name: **Maryam Hussaina Muhammad Rafeek**

Designation: President of CipherNest Cybersecurity Club

Date: 30.05.2026



Reviewed by:

Name: **Dr. Nor Haniza Mohd Khir**

Designation: Club Advisor of CipherNest Cybersecurity Club

Date: 6/6/2026

PROGRAM REVIEW BY THE SCHOOL OF COMPUTING AND INFORMATICS ADVISOR

Comment:

Approved by:

ASSOC.PROF.DR. BASHEER RISKHAN

Designation:

Dean, School of Computing & Informatics, SCI

Advisor, School of Computing & Informatics, SCI

Date:

BUDGET ENDORSEMENT BY THE FINANCIAL CONTROLLER

☐

Endorse

☐

Not endorse

Comment:

(RAFILAH BINTI ABD AZIZ)

Financial Officer

Date:

ENDORSEMENT BY THE DEPUTY VICE CHANCELLOR (ACADEMIC)

☐

Endorse

☐

Not endorse

Comment:

Approved By:

(PROF. DR. HJ. MOHAMAD ABDULLAH @ DON BIN HJ. HEMDI)

Deputy Vice Chancellor (Academic)

Date:

APPROVAL BY THE VICE CHANCELLOR AND PRESIDENT

☐

Approve

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Not approve

Comment:

Approved By:

(PROF. DATO' IR. DR. MOHD SALEH JAAFAR, FASc, FIEM, FAPM)

Vice Chancellor and President

Date: